

1. Thoughts on GitLab's workforce reduction" and "structural and strategic decisions"

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-05-11T23:58:55+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/May/11/gitlab-act-2/#atom-everything>

GitLab Act 2 There's a lot going on in this announcement from GitLab about the "workforce reduction" and "structural and strategic decisions" they are making with respect to the agentic era. They're "planning to reduce the number of countries by up to 30% where we have small teams". One of the most interesting things about GitLab is that they have employees spread across a large number of countries - 18 are listed in their public employee handbook but this post says they are "operating in nearly 60 countries". That handbook used to document their payroll workflows for those countries too - they stopped publishing that in 2023 but the last public version (hooray for version control) remains a fascinating read. Since we don't know which of those 60 countries have small teams, we can't calculate how many countries that 30% applies to. "We're planning to flatten the organization, removing up to three layers of management in some functions so leaders are closer to the work." - this isn't the first announcement of this type I've seen that's trimming management. Coinbase recently announced a much more aggressive version of this: they were "flattening our org structure to 5 layers max bel...

2. Quoting James Shore

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-05-11T19:48:32+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/May/11/james-shore/#atom-everything>

Your AI coding agent, the one you use to write code, needs to reduce your maintenance costs. Not by a little bit, either. You write code twice as quick now? Better hope you've halved your maintenance costs. Three times as productive? One third the maintenance costs. Otherwise, you're screwed. You're trading a temporary speed boost for permanent indenture. [...] The math only works if the LLM decreases your maintenance costs, and by exactly the inverse of the rate it adds code. If you double your output and your cost of maintaining that output, two times two means you've quadrupled your maintenance costs. If you double your output and hold your maintenance costs steady, two times one means you've still doubled your maintenance costs. ? James Shore , You Need AI That Reduces Maintenance Costs Tags: coding-agents , ai-assisted-programming , generative-ai , agentic-engineering , ai , llms

3. Your AI Use Is Breaking My Brain

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-05-11T19:21:27+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/May/11/zombie-internet/#atom-everything>

Your AI Use Is Breaking My Brain Excellent, angry piece by Jason Koebler on how AI writing online is becoming impossible to avoid, filtering it is mentally exhausting and it's even starting to distort regular human writing styles. I particularly liked his use of the term "Zombie Internet" to define a different, more insidious alternative to the "Dead Internet" (which is just bots talking to each other): I called it the Zombie Internet because the truth is that large parts of the internet are not just bots talking to bots or bots talking to people. It's people talking to bots, people talking to people, people creating ?AI agents? and then instructing them to interact with people. It's people using AI talking to people who are not using AI, and it's people using AI talking to other people who are using AI. It's influencer hustlers who are teaching each other how to make AI influencers and have spun up automated YouTube channels and blogs and social media accounts that are spamming the internet for the sole purpose of making money. It is whatever the fuck ?Moltbook? is and whatever the fuck X and LinkedIn have become. It's AI summaries of real books being sold as the book itself an...

4. [Sponsor] Drata

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-05-12T00:54:08Z

Link: <https://drata.com/daring>

Leverage autonomous AI agents to automate compliance, manage internal and third-party risk, and continuously prove your security posture. ?

5. iOS 26.5 Includes Beta Support for End-to-End Encrypted RCS Messaging

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-05-11T22:57:00Z

Link: <https://www.apple.com/newsroom/2026/05/end-to-end-encrypted-rcs-messaging-begins-rolling-out-today-in-beta/>

Apple Newsroom: Starting today, end-to-end encrypted RCS messaging begins rolling out in beta for iPhone users running iOS 26.5 with supported carriers and Android users on the latest version of Google Messages. When RCS messages are end-to-end encrypted, they can't be read while they're sent between devices. Users will know that a conversation is end-to-end encrypted when they see a new lock icon in their RCS chats. Encryption is on by default and will be automatically enabled over time for new and existing RCS conversations. I hope this leads to a future where all RCS messages are end-to-end encrypted, but I doubt it. Currently this E2EE RCS depends both on the carriers (of both parties) in a direct chat, and the software running on their devices. The carrier list is pretty broad, but as far as I can tell, it still doesn't include Google's own Google Fi . But the indication for this is subtle. You have to read the small print metadata in each chat to see if it's encrypted. The message text remains the same shade of green. If it's a group chat and even one single member isn't on a phone and carrier that supports E2EE RCS, the entire chat will not be encrypted. With iMessage, all...

6. iPhone Models Ranked 1st, 2nd, 3rd, and 6th in Counterpoint's List of 10 Bestselling Phones Worldwide in Q1 2026

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-05-11T20:48:05Z

Link: <https://appleworld.today/2026/05/apples-iphone-17-was-the-worlds-best-selling-smartphone-in-quarter-one-of-2026/>

Samsung phones took spots 4, 5, 7, 8, and 9. The one phone not from Apple or Samsung in the top 10 was the Xiaomi Redmi A5 at #10. As I always say , take these numbers with a grain of salt, but according to Counterpoint, the bestselling phones, in order, are: iPhone 17 iPhone 17 Pro Max iPhone 17 Pro And Apple's phone in spot #6 was not the iPhone Air, alas, but the year-old iPhone 16. (Via Horace Dediu .) ?

7. Additional notes on controlling which handles are inherited by CreateProcess

Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Mon, 11 May 2026 14:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20260511-00/?p=112313>

Putting the handles in a private container. The post Additional notes on controlling which handles are inherited by CreateProcess appeared first on The Old New Thing .

8. We Are Not Going to Agree on AI

Source: iDiallo.com | Published: Mon, 11 May 2026 12:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://idiallo.com/blog/we-are-not-going-to-agree-on-ai?src=feed>

On one hand, I know a developer producing 30,000 lines of code a month. On the other, I know a developer who says AI is stupid. Each swears by their stance and has evidence to back it up. One has a working product and the other has a broken one. The New York Times profiled Medvi and reported they're on track to make \$1.8 billion this year. Clearly AI worked for them... if you ignore the alleged fraud for just a second. And while Microsoft now claims that at least 30% of their code is AI-generated , GitHub logged 89 incidents in 90 days (as of this writing). That doesn't exactly paint a bright picture of a technology firing on all cylinders. If you're sitting on the sidelines trying to decide whether AI works or not, you're not going to get a clean answer. But it's still the right question to be asking. I don't think we'll ever reach a consensus, because after all the hype, what we're left with is a capable tool. And apparently, that's not enough. For AI companies, it's supposed to be the alpha and the omega. Something that will both kill us and save us , take all our jobs and liberate us at the same time. For the rest of us, if we're not afraid, it's proof we don't understand it..

9. Thinking Machines and interaction models

Source: seangoedecke.com RSS feed | Published: Tue, 12 May 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://seangoedecke.com/interaction-models/>

Thinking Machines just released Interaction Models . This is their first real AI model release 1 after a year of work and two billion dollars of capital. What is an ?interaction model?? First, it?s not a frontier model . Thinking Machines is not yet competing with OpenAI, Anthropic and Google. Instead, they?re working on the problem of better real-time interaction with models. Some parts of what they?re doing are not new at all, other parts are slightly-questionable benchmark gaming, and still other parts represent a genuine technological advancement. I?ll try to lay it all out. Fully-duplex voice models If you?ve used ChatGPT in audio mode, you know that you can?t talk to it exactly how you?d talk to a human. There?s a big latency gap between when you finish talking and when the model jumps in. The model won?t interrupt you like a human, and doesn?t react to you interrupting it like a human would either. And of course you can?t give the model visual feedback like facial expressions. That?s because ChatGPT is either speaking or listening at any given time . When you?re talking, it?s in ?listening? mode; when it?s talking, it?s in ?speaking? mode, and isn?t absorbing any informatio...

10. Moving from lsp-mode in GNU Emacs to Eglot

Source: Chris's Wiki :: blog | Published: 2026-05-11T03:16:42Z

Link: <https://utcc.utoronto.ca/~cks/space/blog/programming/EmacsLspModeToEglot>

Recently, I decided to take my long standing , perfectly good GNU Emacs lsp-mode setup and completely replace it with Eglot, the now built in GNU Emacs LSP solution. At one level I didn't have any particularly strong specific reason to switch; I started by trying out Eglot after switching entirely to Corfu then just kept going to see how far I could get towards a good Eglot environment. The result is perfectly good and some things work better (Eglot will do 'complete to common prefix' in Go and Python modes) but it took more than a little bit of yak shaving to get here. At another level, lsp-mode with lsp-ui is what I'd call a busy interface, with all sorts of things going on, and these days I've decided that I want a quieter LSP experience. Eglot is famously more minimal and quiet than lsp-mode, although you can and should augment Eglot's interface with additional packages . I could have tamed lsp-ui more with additional settings and fiddling, but switching to Eglot took care of all of that all at once, with other benefits. Overall I'm happy to have switched, although it was more work than I was entirely expecting. (Should you switch? I don't know, but if you stick with GNU Emacs...

11. Euler function

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Tue, 12 May 2026 00:49:41 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/05/11/euler-function/>

This morning I wrote a post about the probability that a random matrix over a finite field is invertible. If the field has q elements and the matrix has dimensions $n \times n$ then the probability is $\prod_{k=1}^n (1 - q^{-k})$. In that post I made observation that $p(q, n)$ converges very quickly as a function of n [1]. [?] The post Euler function first appeared on John D. Cook .

12. Inverse shift

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Mon, 11 May 2026 15:30:30 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/05/11/inverse-shift/>

What is the inverse of shifting a sequence to the right? Shifting it to the left, obviously. But wait a minute. Suppose you have a sequence of eight bits abcdefgh and you shift it to the right. You get 0abcdefg. If you shift this sequence to the left you get abcdefg0 You can?t recover the [?] The post Inverse shift first appeared on John D. Cook .

13. Probability that a random binary matrix is invertible

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Mon, 11 May 2026 13:25:13 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/05/11/random-binary-matrices/>

The two latest posts have involved invertible matrices with 0 and 1 entries. If you fill an $n \times n$ matrix with 0s and 1s randomly, how likely is it to be invertible? What kind of inverse? There are a couple ways to find the probability that a binary matrix is invertible, depending on what [?] The post Probability that a random binary matrix is invertible first appeared on John D. Cook .

14. Hosting a website on an 8-bit microcontroller.

Source: Maurycy's Blog | Published: Mon, 11 May 2026 00:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://maurycyz.com/projects/mcusize/>

In today's episode of "dumb things to do with an AVR microcontroller": Does your server come with real wood? MCU website demo (may go down if this gets posted to HN) My victim is the AVR64DD32 which is quite similar to the Atmega328 of Arduino fame. Compared to the older Atmega, these are cheaper for the same memory, use a single programming pin and have nicer peripherals: CPU: Single 8-bit AVR core @ 24 MHz (max) RAM: 8 kB (static RAM) Flash: 64 kB EEPROM: 256 bytes Voltage: 1.8 - 5.5 Volts Cost: \$1 So that's the computer (and a rather spacious one at that) but it'll need an internet connection to host a website. The obvious choice is Ethernet , but even the slowest version (10BASE-T) still runs at 10 megabits/second. Worse, it uses Manchester encoding: a zero is sent as "10" and a one as "01", so 10 megabits of data is actually 20 megabits at the wire. This is simply too fast for the AVR to generate. While it's processor can run at 24 MHz, but all the peripherals and IO pins max out at 12 MHz. (although some other 8-bit chips can manage it) The proper solution is to buy a dedicated ethernet chip from DigiKey, but then I'd be waiting weeks to finish this project. ... and ethernet...

15. I'm really frustrated that GitLab is doing layoffs

Source: Xe Iaso's blog | Published: Mon, 11 May 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://xeiaso.net/notes/2026/gitlab-layoffs/>

Winning at this could have been so easy

16. Find blog posts with missing featured images - and missing alt text - without a plugin

Source: Terence Eden's Blog | Published: Mon, 11 May 2026 11:34:39 +0000

Link: <https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/05/find-blog-posts-with-missing-featured-images-and-missing-alt-text-without-a-plugin/>

WordPress has the concept of "Featured Images". They are the images which show up when you share a blog post on social media or, on some themes, as the "hero" image. How can you quickly and easily find any posts which don't have a featured image? For this, I use WP CLI - it allows you to run complex WordPress actions and queries using the command line. After you have installed WP CLI you can?

17. proxy

Source: Andrew Nesbitt | Published: 2026-05-11T10:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://nesbitt.io/2026/05/11/proxy.html>

Building tools that talk to package registries means making thousands of requests to npm, RubyGems, PyPI, and crates.io while you iterate, and at some point you start to feel bad about it. Recorded HTTP fixtures go stale, mocking sixteen different registry protocols by hand is its own project, and pointing the test suite at the real thing means every red-green cycle is a few hundred more requests to infrastructure other people are paying for. I wanted something I could point git-pkgs and brief at locally that would answer like the real registries do but only fetch from upstream once. proxy is a single Go binary that speaks the wire protocols of npm, PyPI, RubyGems, Cargo, Go modules, Maven, NuGet, Composer, Hex, pub.dev, Conan, Conda, CRAN, Debian, RPM, and the OCI container registry. Start it, point a package manager at localhost:8080 , and the first install fetches from upstream and writes the artifact to local storage; every install after that is served from the cache. Metadata responses are rewritten on the way through so tarball URLs point back at the proxy rather than the origin, which is the part most simple HTTP caches get wrong. proxy & npm_config_registry = http://localh...

18. The Problem of Pedagogy in Advanced Mathematics

Source: Susam Pal | Published: 2026-05-11T00:00:00Z

Link: <https://susam.net/advanced-mathematics-pedagogy.html>

It is a commonly held opinion that educational institutions could do more to improve the pedagogy of mathematics. This is especially true in school, when students are first exposed to new subjects. Poor exposition can turn students away from mathematics for a lifetime. Only the highly motivated ones continue to engage with the subject. This is very unfortunate because mathematics is a beautiful subject and it is filled with wonder. It also teaches rigour in reasoning, clarity of thought and the discipline of constructing arguments from first principles to obtain intricate and often beautiful results. What is perhaps less known is that pedagogy is a problem even for graduate-level mathematics students and professional mathematicians. The proofs in many graduate-level mathematics textbooks are, in my humble opinion, not really proofs at all. They are closer to high-level outlines of proofs. The authors simply do not show their work. The student then has to put in an extraordinary amount of effort to understand and justify each line. Sometimes a 10-line argument in a textbook might expand into a 10-page proof if the student really wants to convince themselves that the argument works....

19. Pluralistic: 2024 (apart from the obvious) (11 May 2026)

Source: Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow | Published: Mon, 11 May 2026 09:43:59 +0000

Link: <https://pluralistic.net/2026/05/11/postmortem/>

Today's links 2024 (apart from the obvious): Some unforced errors. Hey look at this: Delights to delectate. Object permanence: Denmark legalizing music trading; Babysuit; Patent Office invites "peer review"; DRM protest at the Bastille; Scientology's "super powers"; Banana Dalek; Florida v pediatricians' gun safety advice; Copyright filters and wage theft; "Who Broke the Internet?" Vatican astronomer v Creationism; Teens, privacy and Facebook; ?apek's graveside robot; Save iTunes; NZ laundered money for Latinamerica's looters; Memex Method. Upcoming appearances: Barcelona, Berlin, Hay-on-Wye, London, NYC, Edinburgh. Recent appearances: Where I've been. Latest books: You keep readin' em, I'll keep writin' 'em. Upcoming books: Like I said, I'll keep writin' 'em. Colophon: All the rest. 2024 (apart from the obvious) (permalink) Just as Hillary Clinton positioned her run as a third term for Obama ("America is already great"), so did Biden (and then Harris) position their campaigns as a second Biden term. As Biden said (in 2019): "Nothing would fundamentally change": <https://www.salon.com/2019/06/19/joe-biden-to-rich-donors-nothing-would-fundamentally-change-if-hes-elected/> So a vote f...

20. Fear is information.

Source: Westenberg. | Published: Mon, 11 May 2026 03:52:45 GMT

Link: <https://www.joanwestenberg.com/fear-is-information/>

The motivational industry has built any number of small empires on the notion that fear is a problem to be either managed, suppressed or out-manoeuvred. Fight the fear, etc. The language is typically martial - as if fear were a hostile enemy, camped at the gates of your better self.

21. Out With the JS, In With the HTML

Source: Jim Nielsen's Blog | Published: Sun, 10 May 2026 19:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://blog.jim-nielsen.com/2026/out-with-js-in-with-html/>

I've been posting about how you can make lots of HTML pages and leverage navigations over in-page, JS-dependent interactions. Now I'm gonna post another example. On my icon sites, I have a little widget that allows you to resize the icons you're looking at. Previously, I implemented this functionality as a web component that looked something like this: `icon-list size = "md" > a href = "" > img src = "" width = "128" height = "128" /> a > a href = "" > img src = "" width = "128" height = "128" /> a > icon-list` > The size attribute corresponded to an enumeration like `sm | md | lg | xl` which mapped to actual pixel dimensions like `64x64` or

512512. When the little widget was clicked to render icons at a different size, JavaScript changed the size attribute on the custom element. From there, the web component's JS took over changing the dimensions of the children elements, their src attributes, etc. It all worked pretty well. However, because that was a client-side solution to my otherwise entirely pre-rendered static site, it required some templating logic and data be duplicated and sent over the wire to every client. I didn't love that for various reasons ? like ?Crap, I updated thi...

22. Welcoming the Bangladesh Government to Have I Been Pwned

Source: Troy Hunt | Published: Mon, 11 May 2026 22:27:32 GMT

Link: <https://www.troyhunt.com/welcoming-the-bangladesh-government-to-have-i-been-pwned/>

Today, we welcome the 43rd government onboarded to Have I Been Pwned's free gov service, Bangladesh. The BGD e-GOV CIRT department now has full access to query all their government domains via API, and monitor them against future breaches. Bangladesh joins a growing list of national governments using

23. History of PowerDNS: 1999-2003

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Fri, 27 Nov 2020 12:29:55 +0100

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/history-of-powerdns-1999-2003/>

Hi everyone, I have often told the history of PowerDNS, or at least how I recall it, during talks and presentations. As I am about to truly leave DNS and PowerDNS, I thought it was high time to document my recollections. Since this is a 20+ year old story right now, it is very possible I have forgotten or misremembered important things. Do let me know if you miss important things, or if you recall things differently!

24. IKEA TRADFRI for Rebooting a Server or Modem

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Wed, 25 Nov 2020 12:20:33 +0100

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/ikea-tradfri-for-rebooting-serve-or-modem/>

Recently I revamped my home internet, and (hopefully) temporarily ended up with a modem that needs to be power cycled from time to time. We're working on getting it fixed, but in the meantime I needed a solution for automated power cycling. There are various ways to turn the power off or on from a Linux computer, and some of these are very karmic. You can get a zigbee USB stick and ditto power plugs, and I am sure this is a lot of fun.

25. Regulatory Capture, of de 'Gevangen Regelgever'

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Tue, 24 Nov 2020 14:44:40 +0100

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/gevangen-regelgevers/>

Op verzoek van iemand uit de elektriciteitswereld, een stukje over de 'Gevangen Regelgever', beter bekend als 'Regulatory Capture'. Heel in het kort is dit een zeer veel voorkomende situatie waarbij een toezichthouder (of regelgever) langzaam maar zeker de wereld gaat zien door de ogen van de sector waar toezicht op wordt gehouden. Dit leidt dan tot toezicht wat behulpzaam is voor die industrie, maar niet efficiënt bijdraagt aan een betere samenleving of verbeterde veiligheid.